



Presented by The High End

HEE-1 INTERSTELLAR COCKPIT

Life-Size Space Cockpit — Sit-In Command Station

Build a full mission control cockpit. The living room is now the launchpad.

AGES 4–12	BOXES 3–4 Large Boxes	TIME 2 Hours	DIFF Intermediate **	PIECES 6 pcs
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CARDBOARD NEEDED:
3–4 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each)

MISSION GOAL:
Build a fully enclosed cockpit: U-shaped console, command seat, main screen, control panels on all surfaces.



CONSOLE FRONT PANEL

24" x 24" (61 x 61 cm) | Cut x1

CUT
x1

CONSOLE FRONT PANEL

x1

CUT BUTTON/CONTROL SHAPES into top surface — fill every inch

BASE FOLD — panel stands upright in front of seat

24" x 24" (61 x 61 cm)
Main front console — faces the pilot

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT — scissors or box cutter on this line

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Main front console — faces the pilot



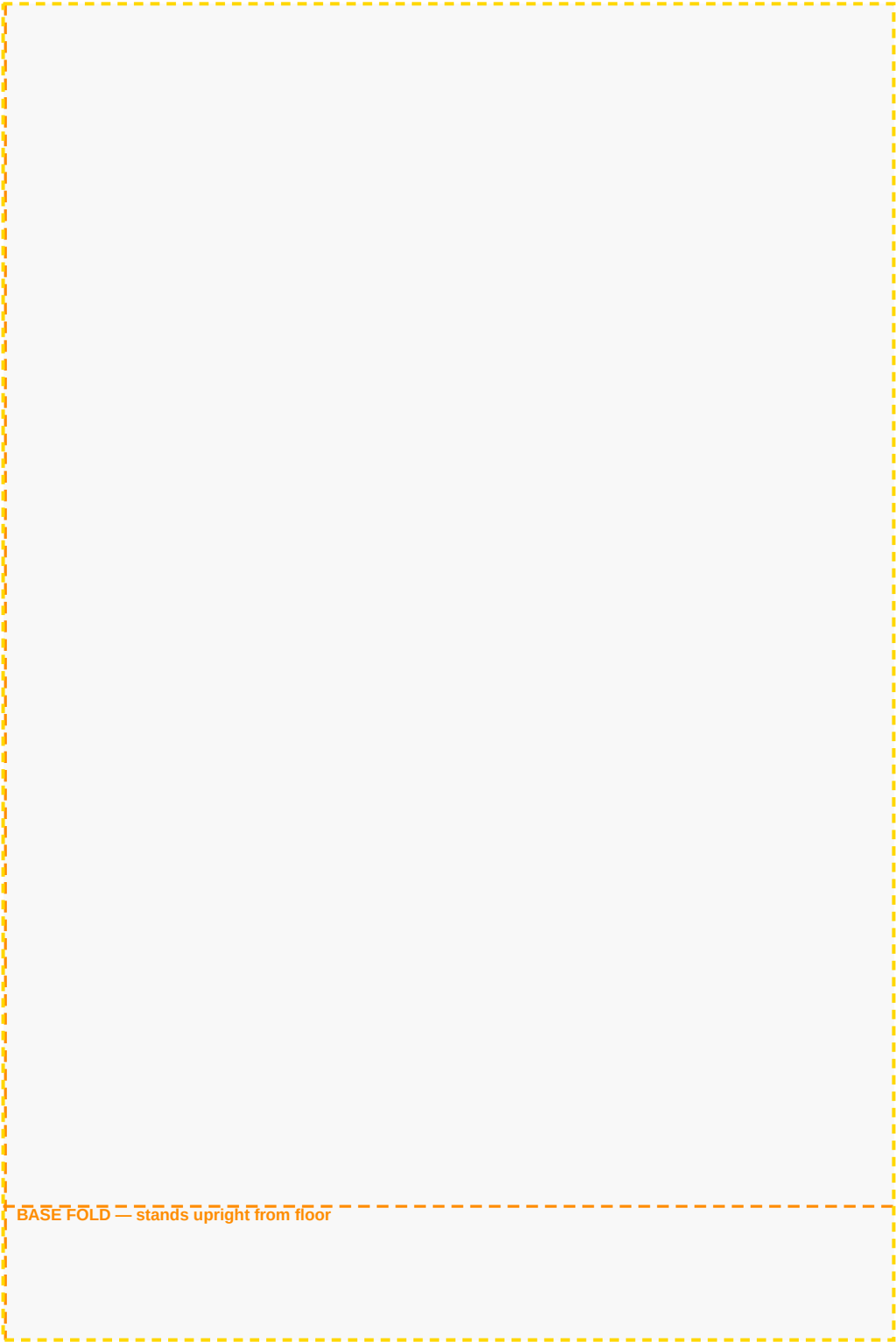
CONSOLE SIDE PANEL

16" x 24" (41 x 61 cm) | Cut x2

CUT
x2

CONSOLE SIDE PANEL

x2



BASE FOLD — stands upright from floor

16" x 24" (41 x 61 cm)
Left and right sides of the U

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Left and right sides of the U



SEAT BACK

16" x 24" (41 x 61 cm) | Cut x1

CUT
x1

SEAT BACK

x1

16" x 24" (41 x 61 cm)
High-back command chair

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: High-back command chair



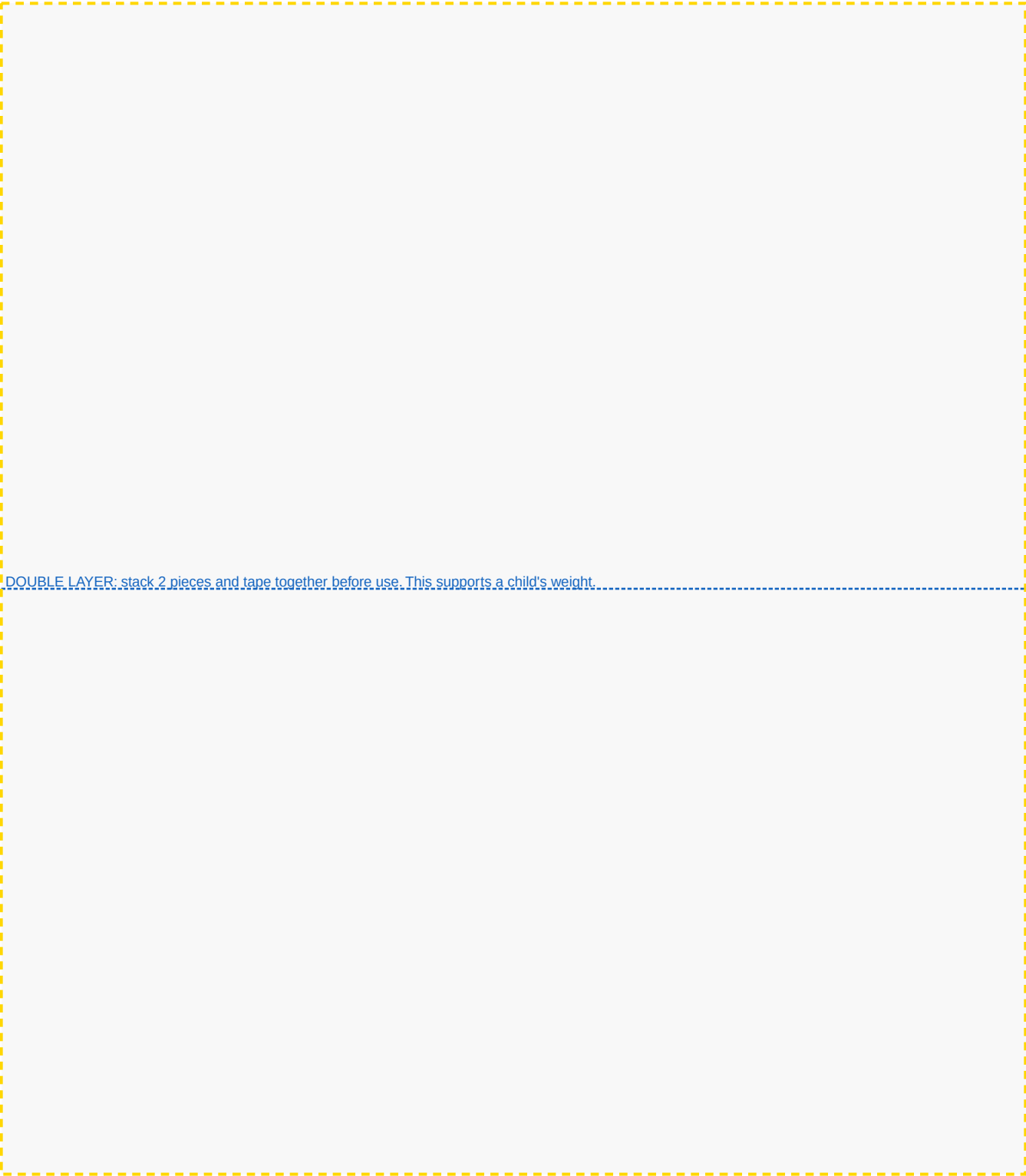
SEAT BASE

14" × 16" (36 × 41 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

SEAT BASE

x1



DOUBLE LAYER: stack 2 pieces and tape together before use. This supports a child's weight.

14" × 16" (36 × 41 cm)

Child sits here — DOUBLE LAYER for strength

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

SCORE — press hard with ruler but do NOT cut through

NOTE: Child sits here — DOUBLE LAYER for strength



MAIN SCREEN PANEL

20" × 16" (51 × 41 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

MAIN SCREEN PANEL

x1

BASE FOLD — stands upright behind the console

20" × 16" (51 × 41 cm)
Stands upright — paint star field on it

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Stands upright — paint star field on it



CONTROL DETAIL STRIP

16" x 4" (41 x 10 cm) | Cut x6

CUT
x6

CONTROL DETAIL STRIP

x6

CUT BUTTON + GAUGE SHAPES into this strip — fill every inch with controls

16" x 4" (41 x 10 cm)
Rows of controls along console surfaces

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT — scissors or box cutter on this line

NOTE: Rows of controls along console surfaces

WHAT YOU NEED — HEE-1 INTERSTELLAR COCKPIT

CARDBOARD PIECES — 6 TOTAL (3–4 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each))



Console Front Panel

24" × 24"

Main front console — faces the pilot



Console Side Panel

16" × 24"

Left and right sides of the U



Seat Back

16" × 24"

High-back command chair



Seat Base

14" × 16"

Child sits here — DOUBLE LAYER for strength



Main Screen Panel

20" × 16"

Stands upright — paint star field on it



Control Detail Strip

16" × 4"

Rows of controls along console surfaces

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

+ 3–4 large cardboard boxes

+ Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY

+ Packing tape

+ BLACK PAINT (entire cockpit goes black first)

+ Gold + silver markers for control highlights

+ Small cardboard scraps for buttons, gauges, levers

FUN FACT!

The International Space Station cockpit has over 1,000 switches. Add as many fake ones as you want.

CHALLENGE!

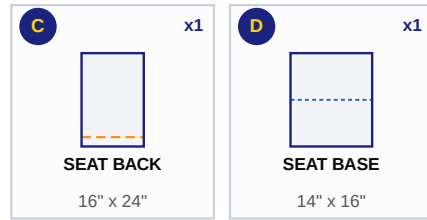
Mission debrief! Once seated, the pilot gives a 30-second report: Where are we going? What's the mission? What's the crew name?

1

STEP 1: BUILD THE SEAT

Tape the Seat Base flat — double layer it for strength (score mark on template shows this). Tape the Seat Back upright at the rear. Add armrests from scrap cardboard. The seat must hold a child's weight.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



2

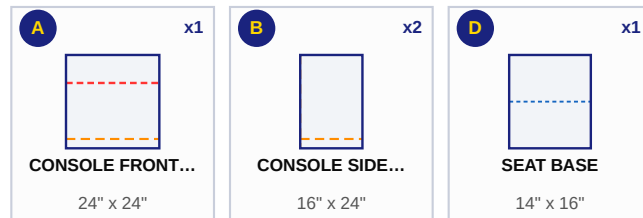
STEP 2: BUILD THE CONSOLE

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Tape the Console Front Panel upright in front of the seat (base fold mark on template). Tape one Console Side Panel on each side (inner edge + base fold marks). This creates the U-shape that wraps around the pilot.

SAFETY: Two people needed to hold the U-shape together while taping.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

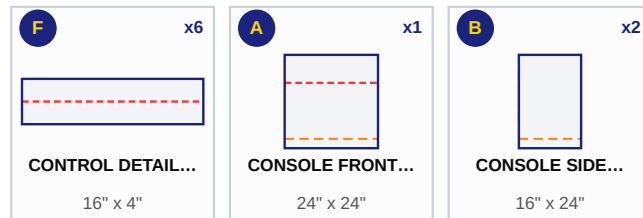


3

STEP 3: FILL THE CONSOLE WITH CONTROLS

Using the cut marks on Console panels and Control Detail Strips: cut and score button shapes, gauge circles, lever slots across EVERY surface. Tape Control Detail Strips to the console surfaces. No empty flat space. Label key controls: THRUST, SHIELDS, COMMS, WEAPONS, HEE-1.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

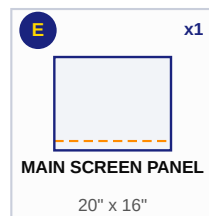


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STEP 4: ADD THE MAIN SCREEN

Stand the Main Screen Panel upright behind the console (base fold mark). Paint a star field, a planet, or a navigation grid on it. Label it MISSION SCREEN.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



5

STEP 5: PAINT MATTE BLACK

Paint the entire cockpit matte black — seat, all console surfaces, screen. Every surface. This is the foundation. Gold and silver only pop because the background is black.

6

STEP 6: ADD GOLD & SILVER HIGHLIGHTS

Trace every button edge and panel border in gold marker. Highlight gauge rings in silver. Label prominently: HEE-1 COMMAND. Add a mission clock. Add crew names. Add a mission badge.

7

STEP 7: QUALITY CHECK

Child sits in the seat. Console wraps on 3 sides. Main screen in view. Controls reachable. Cockpit feels enclosed. Gold and silver on black. Compare to cover photo. That's the standard.

QUALITY CHECK!

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations